

soil conditions as sweet varieties, they will happily grow in cooler locations—even trained against a north-facing wall or fence.

Dig in some well-rotted manure or compost shortly before planting. Your trees will need support, so insert stakes for freestanding trees before planting, and stake and fix horizontal wires in place for trees to be trained. Some compact varieties of cherry can be grown in containers; ensure that your pot is at least 18 in (45 cm) deep and that the soil is well-drained.

CROP CARE

Cherry trees should be kept well-watered while they are young and need an application of a balanced fertilizer in early



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spring. Mulch around the base of trees with well-rotted manure or compost after feeding. Sour cherries will also benefit from a late winter feeding with a nitrogen-rich fertilizer.

Bear in mind that due to their restricted conditions, container-grown trees will need more water than those planted outside—they

TIP PRUNING

- When the tree is young, prune to encourage strong growth. Once the tree is established, prune in early spring to encourage growth and again in summer after fruiting.
- Use sterilized tools. Prune out any diseased or damaged wood first.
- Prune strategically so that branches are not crossing or rubbing—the tree is vulnerable to infection if the bark has been rubbed away.



Prune in spring when blossoms and new leaves are present on the tree.